

Pardis Derakhshandeh

Linguistics Department, Stony Brook University
100 Nicolls Road, Stony Brook, NY 11790
Email: pardis.derakhshandeh@stonybrook.edu
Website: pardisDerakhshandeh.github.io

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Theoretical** Formal Syntax · Morphosyntax · Argument Structure · Ergativity and Complex Alignment
- Languages** **Western Iranian languages:** Behbahani, Kurdish Varieties (Kurmanji, Sorani, Hawrami), Persian, and Southwestern Varieties (Dashti, Davani)
Historical: Old and Middle Persian: diachronic development of ergative alignment

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. in Linguistics** 2021–Present
Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY
Dissertation: *The Architecture of Argument Licensing in Behbahani*
Committee: Francisco Ordóñez (Chair), Richard Larson, Faruk Akkuş (UMass Amherst)
- M.A. in Linguistics** 2018
University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran
- B.A. in English Language and Literature** 2015
University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran
- NON-DEGREE SEEKING
- Summer Program in Linguistics and Cognitive Science** 2020
NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies

PUBLICATIONS AND CONFERENCE ABSTRACTS

Manuscripts in Preparation

- **Derakhshandeh, P.** *Split Alignment beyond Case in Behbahani*. Manuscript in preparation. (Draft available upon request).
- **Derakhshandeh, P.** *The Syntax–Morphology Interface in Behbahani: A Case Study of Stem Alternation*. Manuscript in preparation. (Draft available upon request).

Peer-reviewed Conference Abstracts

- **Derakhshandeh, P.** (2026). Beyond Tense: The Structural Autonomy of StemP in Behbahani. *The 50th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference (PLC 50) Handbook*.
- **Derakhshandeh, P.** (2025). Introducing Behbahani. *2025 LSA Annual Meeting Program*.

PRESENTATIONS AND TALKS

- **2026.** *Beyond Tense: The Structural Autonomy of StemP in Behbahani*. Poster presented at the 50th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference (PLC 50), University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA.
- **2025.** *Introducing Behbahani*. Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America, Philadelphia, PA.
- **2024.** *Split Alignment beyond Case*. Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY.
- **2023.** *Alignment in Behbahani*. Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY.

- **2018.** *Locus of the NegP in Behbahani*. University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran.
- **2017.** Speaker, “What is Linguistics?” Workshop for undergraduate students. University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran.
- **2016.** *A Study of Color Metaphors in Behbahani*. University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran.

RESEARCH PROJECT

- **Lead Organizer, “Introducing Behbahani to the Linguistics Community”** May–December 2024
 - Organized an LSA Annual Meeting session dedicated to linguistic research on Behbahani, a less-studied Iranian language.
 - Coordinated a team of colleagues and ten student presenters contributing analyses of Behbahani.
 - Mentored student researchers by providing linguistic data and refining research questions.
 - Guided the organization and analysis of linguistic data for conference presentations.
 - Provided detailed feedback on research design and presentation materials.

ORGANIZED SESSIONS AND EVENTS

- **LSA Organized Session:** “Linguists, Meet Behbahani: A Syntax, Morphology, Phonology, and Phonetics Data Blitz.” Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting (with Robert Hoberman and Daniel Greeson). January 2025.
- **Scholarly Seminar on Alice Munro** (Lead Organizer). Department of English Linguistics and Literature, University of Kurdistan. Sanandaj, Iran. November 2013.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stony Brook University - Primary Instructor

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|--|-------------------------|
| • LIN 200: Language in the United States | Winter 2026, 2024, 2023 |
| • LIN 541: Sociolinguistics | Summer 2025 |
| • LIN 541: Bilingualism | Summer 2024 |
| • PER 101: Intensive Elementary Persian | Summer 2022 |

Stony Brook University - Teaching Assistant

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| • LIN 200: Language in the United States | Spring 2026, Fall 2024 |
| • LIN 345 Writing Systems of the World <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Guest Lecturer: Delivered two specialized sessions on “Middle Eastern Writing Systems,” focusing on the evolution and structure of Persian and Kurdish orthographies. | Fall 2025 |
| • LIN 431: The Structure of an Uncommonly Taught Language: Behbahani <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Guest Lecturer & Consultant: Delivered the introductory lecture on the sociolinguistic background and typological features of Behbahani; provided ongoing linguistic consultancy for student fieldwork and data analysis. | Spring 2024 |
| • LIN 320: Structure of English Language | Fall 2023 |
| • LIN 340: Historical Linguistics | Spring 2023 |
| • LIN 307: Sociolinguistics | Fall 2022 |
| • LIN 431: The Structure of an Uncommonly Taught Language: Tati | Spring 2022 |
| • LIN 270: Language and Politics | fall 2021 |

Additional Teaching Assistant

The NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies

- Phonology Seminar: Strict CV Metrics or How to Live without Moras- Summer 2024
- Introduction to Syntax Winter 2024, Summer 2023
- Introduction to Syllable Structure Winter 2024
- Experimental Linguistics Winter 2022
- Semantics Seminar: Missing words and missing worlds winter 2022
- Linguistics field method Summer 2021
- Semantics Seminar: Three or Four Puzzles about Numerals Summer 2021

Additional Instruction

- English Language and Literature Instructor. Tavana high school, Behbahan, Iran. 2012-2021

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Regional Outreach and Recruitment Coordinator for Iran 2024 – Present
The NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies

- Lead student outreach and recruitment efforts in Iran, expanding access to international higher-education programs.
- Facilitate communication between prospective students and academic departments to streamline enrollment.

Staff Member, Student Accessibility Support Center (SASC) 2023 – 2025
Stony Brook University

- Support students with accessibility needs through academic assistance and secure exam proctoring.
- Ensure compliance with accommodation regulations and maintain a distraction-free testing environment.

Graduate Research Assistant Winter 2025
Stony Brook University

- **Collaborative Website Design for Tamil Research:** Developed a specialized website to showcase Tamil linguistic projects and facilitate global research collaboration.
- Integrated data resources to make the Tamil Research Group more accessible to the international linguistics community.

HONORS, AWARDS AND GRANTS

- **Research Fellowship**, Stony Brook University 2021
- **Travel Grant**, Department of Linguistics, Stony Brook University (for PLC 50) 2026
- **Travel Grant**, Department of Linguistics, Stony Brook University (for LSA) 2025
- **Travel Grant**, Department of Linguistics, Stony Brook University (for LSA) 2024
- **1st Place, Distinguished Student Award**, University of Kurdistan 2017
- **Ranked 35th (Top 1%)**, National M.A. Linguistics Exam (3,000 candidates) 2016
- **Best Student-Led Scientific Society Award**, University of Kurdistan 2014

SERVICE & OUTREACH

Stony Brook University

Departmental/ University

- **President**, Stony Brook Linguistics Club 2022–2024

Professional Service

- **Reviewer**, Stony Brook–Yale–NYU–CUNY (SYNC) Conference 2021, 2025

Outreach

- **Instructor**, North American Computational Linguistics Open Competition (NACLO) 2026
 - Prepared high school students for linguistic challenges by introducing formal patterns, structural analysis, and computational logic.

University of Kurdistan

- **Coordinator**, Departmental Colloquium on Linguistics and Cognitive Science 2012–2017
- **Coordinator**, Opening Ceremony of the Kurdish Studies Institute 2017
- **Executive Member**, Second National Conference on Reading 2017
- **Representative**, Linguistics Student Society 2016–2017

LANGUAGES

- **Native:** Behbahani, Persian
- **Advanced:** English, Sorani Kurdish
- **Heritage:** Lori
- **Fieldwork:** Ardalani Kurdish, Kalhori Kurdish, Southern Tati
- **Beginner:** Turkish

COMPUTING

- **Programming:**
 - **Proficient:** L^AT_EX, Git/GitHub
 - **Working Knowledge:** Python, R, Haskell, HTML
- **Experimental Tools:** Praat, ELAN, Qualtrics

Updated July 9, 2026